

Charles Donnelly

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SUMMARY

Product Lead and Client Manager with a technical background, spanning software development, design, and product management. Experienced across startups and venture capital, building products end-to-end while managing the stakeholder and partner relationships. A multidimensional product leader equally comfortable in the code, in the design, and in front of the customer.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Runwayz

Chicago, IL

Head of Product

Jun 2025 - Present

- Owned the product strategy and roadmap, authoring end-to-end journey maps for major features that positioned the product for a projected 40% increase in inbound customers.
- Established a design partner program, engaging directly with customers to integrate the product and serve as their primary point of contact, improving onboarding for early adopters.
- Built and delivered tailored product demos for stakeholders and design partners, gathering partner feedback to continuously shape the roadmap.
- Constructed a ground-up design system and an automated Figma-to-GitHub pipeline with AI-driven workflows (Claude, MCPs), accelerating design-to-engineering handoff 3x.

Donnelly Design

Chicago, IL

Product Lead & Client Manager

Mar 2024 - Present

- Worked as a product developer and product lead for a portfolio of clients, designing and developing custom solutions and integrations (APIs, HubSpot, Stripe, AWS, Google Analytics, Notion, Figma) to extend and enhance their products.
- Partnered hands-on with development teams to assemble efficient product pipelines, turning discovery and research into shipped solutions and cutting product time-to-market 30%.
- Served as primary point of contact and trusted advisor for high-churn-risk clients, achieving a 100% retention rate and converting at-risk relationships into upsells and expansions.

Platform Venture Studio

Chicago, IL

Product Development Lead

Jan 2022 - Mar 2024

- Worked directly with founders to cultivate the right product roadmap and execute on their product vision, prioritizing ruthlessly under tight constraints and simultaneous product launches.
- Built and designed MVPs as a hands-on developer for a diverse portfolio of high-growth startups, shipping scalable products under tight 8-week timelines that contributed to a collective \$5 million in annual recurring revenue.
- Designed and implemented custom integrations (Stripe, Google Analytics, HotJar, HubSpot, AWS) and other software to build scalable, production-ready products in heavily regulated spaces (HIPAA, legal compliance).

EDUCATION

Johns Hopkins Carey Business School

Baltimore, MD

Master of Business Administration

May 2027

Maryland Institute College of Art (Mica)

Baltimore, MD

Master of Design Leadership

May 2027

University of Notre Dame

Notre Dame, IN

Bachelor of Arts, Industrial & Product Design

May 2021

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

University of Notre Dame

Notre Dame, IN

Mentor & Speaker | Race to Revenue

Jun 2025 - Present

- Mentored student-led startups and interns; provided training workshops for Notre Dame's summer accelerator.

University of Notre Dame

Notre Dame, IN

Advisor | Trivialinked

Jul 2026 - Present

- Provided product, design, and strategic guidance to a high-growth, student-led startup.

CORE SKILLS

Product: Product Strategy & Roadmap, Stakeholder & Partner Management, Solutions Consulting, Implementation & Onboarding, Custom Integrations & APIs, AI Workflows (Claude & MCPs), Team Leadership & Mentoring, Prioritization

Design: Design Systems, UI/UX Design, Prototyping, User Research, Journey Mapping, Design-to-Code, Design Thinking, WCAG Accessibility, Inclusive Design

Tools: Figma, Claude, Cursor, GitHub, Stripe, AWS, Google Analytics, Segment, HotJar, HubSpot, Notion, Jira

Interests: Game Design, Startups, Travel, Movies & VFX, Sketching, Skiing, Swimming